

SOC Alert Triage and Alerting Process

This document explains a typical Security Operations Center (SOC) alert triage workflow using screenshots from the TryHackMe SOC Simulator. It can be used as a portfolio artifact demonstrating familiarity with SIEM operations, phishing investigations, and incident handling.

1. SOC Dashboard Overview

The SOC dashboard provides a high-level view of open alerts, alert categories, severity distribution, and investigation statistics. Analysts use this screen to prioritize work based on risk and business impact.

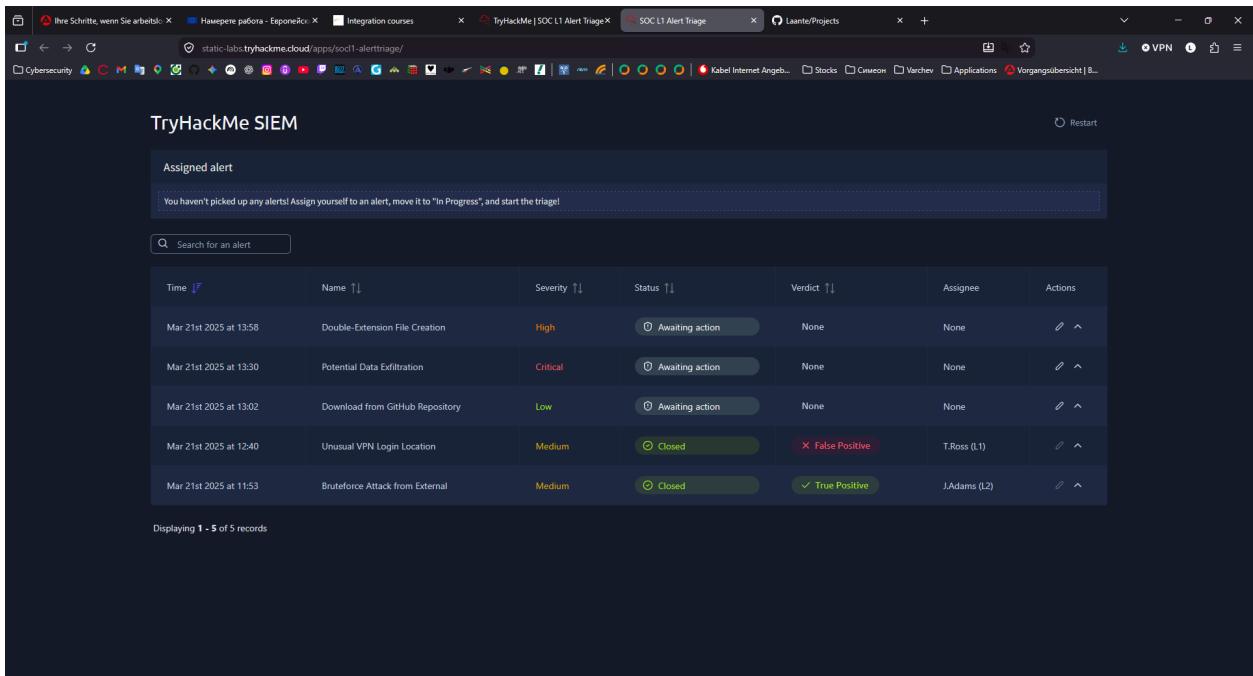


Figure: TryHackMe SOC Simulator

2. Reviewing Alerts in the SIEM

The SIEM lists active and historical alerts with timestamps, severity, status, assignee, and verdict. Selecting an alert reveals investigation details including subject, sender, recipient, authentication results (SPF/DKIM), attachments, and indicators.

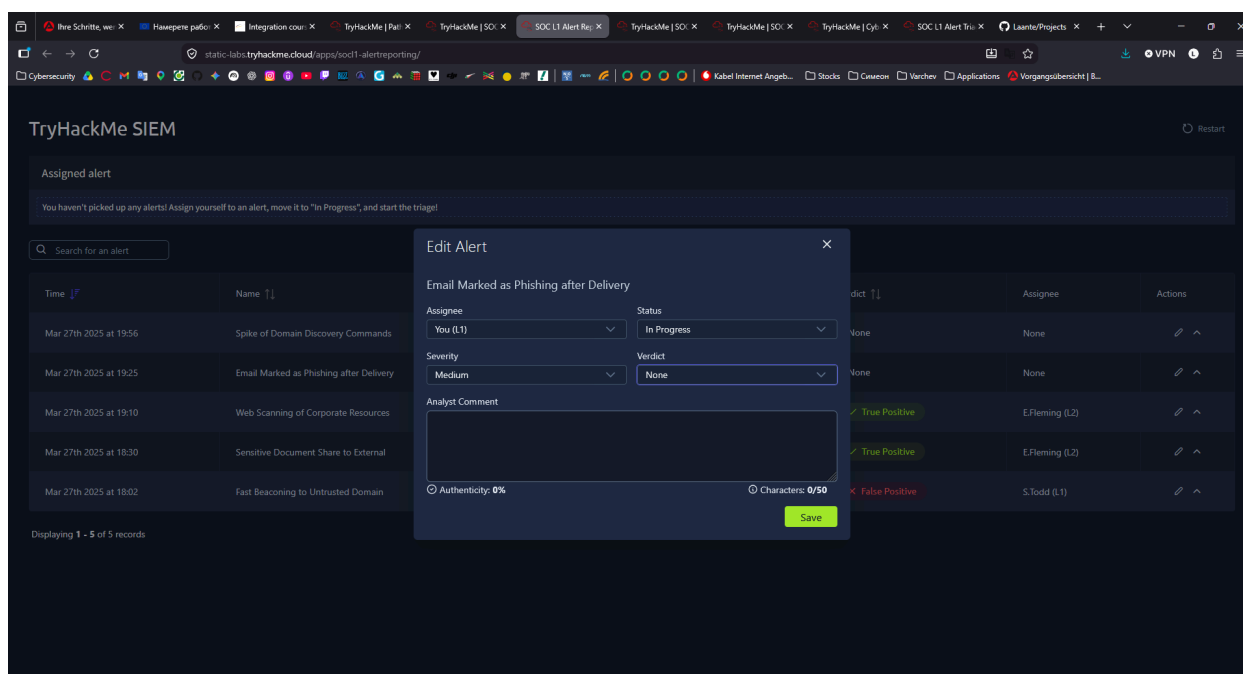


Figure: TryHackMe SOC Simulator

3. Alert Assignment and Triage

The analyst assigns the alert, changes its status to 'In Progress', documents findings, and eventually records a verdict (True Positive or False Positive). Proper documentation creates an audit trail and supports incident response.

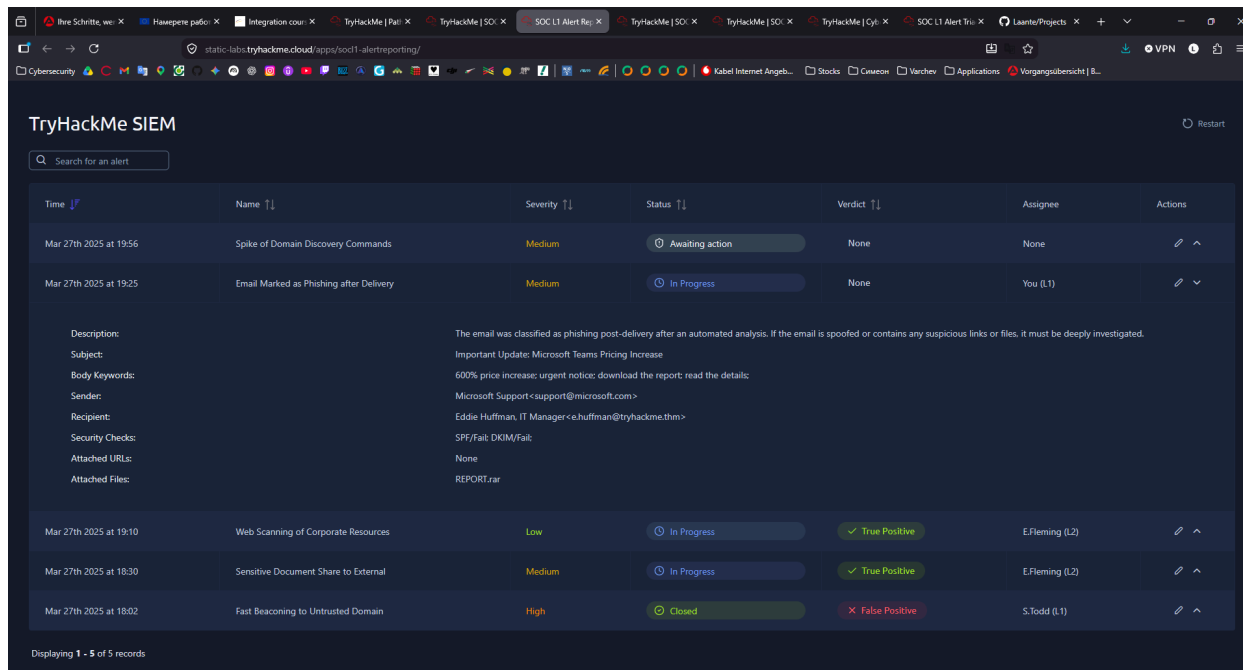


Figure: TryHackMe SOC Simulator

4. Prioritization

Alerts are prioritized according to severity (Low, Medium, High, Critical). High-risk alerts such as data exfiltration or double-extension malware require immediate investigation, while lower-risk alerts are validated and handled according to SOC procedures.

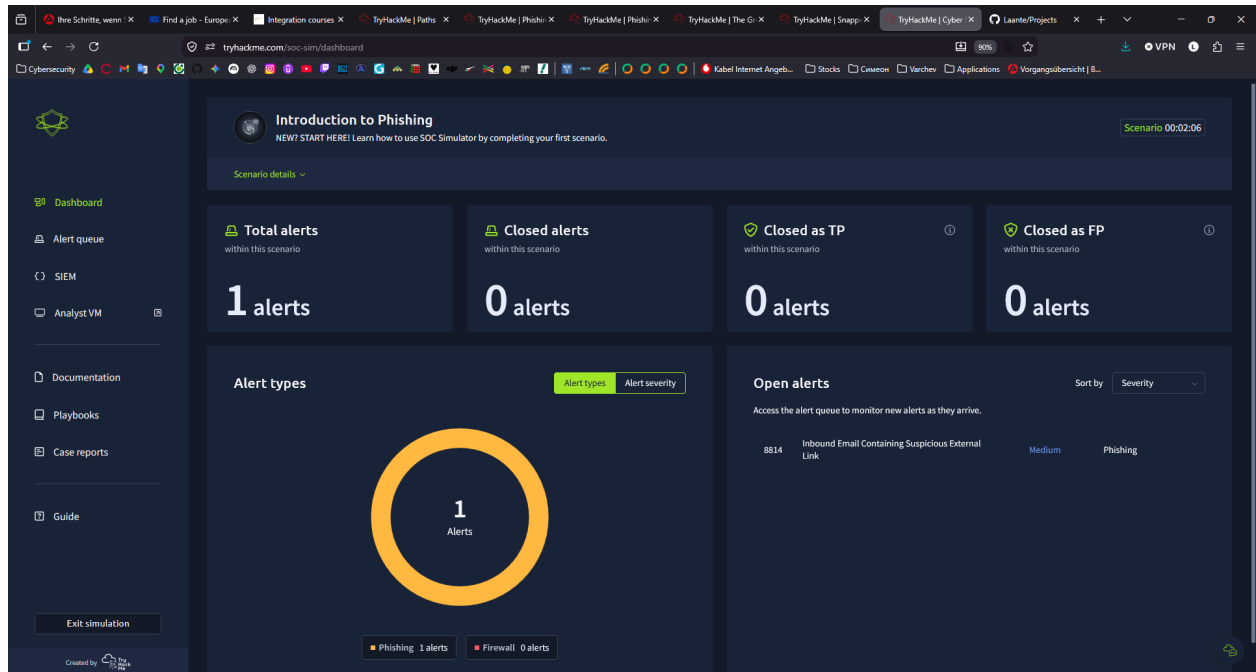


Figure: TryHackMe SOC Simulator

Typical Triage Workflow

- Receive alert generated by SIEM or security control.
- Validate alert metadata (severity, source, timestamp, affected asset).
- Collect evidence from email headers, URLs, attachments, endpoint logs, authentication logs, and threat intelligence.
- Determine whether the activity is malicious, benign, or inconclusive.
- Document findings and assign the appropriate verdict.
- Escalate confirmed incidents to Incident Response when required.
- Close the case after all required actions are completed.

Skills Demonstrated

- SIEM navigation
- Alert prioritization
- Phishing analysis
- Incident documentation
- Threat validation
- True Positive / False Positive classification
- SOC analyst workflow